

buying back a stock at \$19 that you earlier sold at \$11—which may be a perfectly sensible move. Professionals could never buy back a stock at \$19 that they sold at \$11. They'd have their Quotrons confiscated for doing that.

You're not forced to own 1,400 different stocks, nor is anyone going to tell you to sprinkle your money on 100 issues. You're free to own one stock, four stocks, or ten stocks. If no company seems attractive on the fundamentals, you can avoid stocks altogether and wait for a better opportunity. Equity fund managers do not have that luxury, either. We can't sell everything, and when we try, it's always all at once, and then there's nobody buying at decent prices.

Most important, you can find terrific opportunities in the neighborhood or at the workplace, months or even years before the news has reached the analysts and the fund managers they advise.

Then again, maybe you shouldn't have anything to do with the stock market, ever. That's an issue worth discussing in some detail, because the stock market demands conviction as surely as it victimizes the unconvinced.